

Chapter 125-1

At the critical moment, Liang Shi backhanded a strike at Chen Liuying's elbow.

Chen Liuying's arm instantly went numb, losing all strength. As the knife fell, Liang Shi twisted her neck at lightning speed. The knife grazed past the side of her neck, leaving a stinging pain wherever it passed, along with a trace of coldness.

But her body couldn't afford to care about that right now. She had to continue fighting. When one's life hung by a thread, human potential would be infinitely amplified. In just moments, Liang Shi's eyes turned bloodshot as she and Chen Liuying rolled across the ground again and again.

Her body was covered in filth and mud, but she couldn't care less.

Rainwater had spread across the floor of the dark chemical factory. Outside, the rain pattered down, falling on grass and rooftops, producing particularly intense, muffled sounds.

The dark clouds on the distant horizon were like a disciplined army, drifting toward the center in an orderly fashion. Accompanied by rumbling thunder, the sky grew ever more overcast.

Lightning broke through the oppressive cloud cover, tearing open a gash in the sky, only to disappear an instant later as the dark clouds closed back together seamlessly.

Darkness swallowed the light.

The smell inside the abandoned factory was already unpleasant, and now mixed with rainwater, it carried the scent of rotting wood, traces of chemical elements, and the rust of long-neglected metal.

All these smells mixed together, assaulting one's senses with tremendous impact.

At this moment, two strands of Liang Shi's hair hung beside her cheeks, her hands never stopping for a moment.

Unlike the fight choreography she practiced with the film crew, unlike the techniques she trained at the practice grounds, every move now used all her strength with a single purpose—to pin down her opponent.

As quickly as possible, as forcefully as possible...

But Chen Liuying had been training her body intensely to attract female fans, and both her explosive power and endurance were strong. Gradually, Liang Shi felt her strength flagging, but she didn't slack off in the slightest.

Even with her body feeling unwell, she still fought Chen Liuying to a draw—in fact, Chen Liuying had more injuries than she did.

Liang Shi "accidentally" kicked the knife away, and it landed not far from Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu kept her attention on the battle between the two while stretching her foot out to reach that knife.

All the blood in her body felt cold. She didn't dare blink, terrified that Liang Shi might be hurt in the next second.

This scene no longer overlapped with the past.

The Liang Shi of before had been too weak, only able to passively endure everything.

But now she was bravely fighting back, desperately protecting herself.

Xu Qingzhu's heart felt like it was being bitten by tens of thousands of ants—sour and painful. Fear and terror kept spreading through her body. The emotions she had been desperately trying to control were becoming impossible to hold back.

Xu Qingzhu kept telling herself: You need to be okay. Don't drag Liang Shi down.

Her rationality was like a tall building, constantly teetering on the verge of collapse, yet pulled back countless times.

The tug-of-war of emotions was more terrifying than physical pain.

When emotions were being pulled to extremes, her body felt like it was being pierced by needles, the pain almost suffocating her.

Physiological tears kept falling, but she didn't dare cry out loud.

Despair, helplessness, pain...

The rain was pouring down. The sounds of fighting in the distance were becoming almost inaudible.

Xu Qingzhu could only force herself to get the knife, cut the ropes on her wrists, then cut the ropes on her feet. As long as she was free, Liang Shi wouldn't be constrained.

She couldn't be Liang Shi's burden again.

"Jiejie, let's go outside." The young little girl said from within the haystack. "They're definitely not there anymore."

Young Liang Shi frowned and said in a low voice: "Let's wait a bit longer..."

"But my face hurts..." The little princess who had been pampered all her life already had a red rash on her face.

Liang Shi gritted her teeth. "Then I'll go first..."

Before she could finish speaking, the haystack shielding their small bodies was already pulled aside.

Those people's ugly faces appeared before them.

The two children looked at them in terror, wanting to run again, but were grabbed by the backs of their necks.

"I told you I heard something." One person said smugly, slapping Liang Shi on the back. "You little brat, you still dare to run!"

"Your ears sure are sharp." Another person laughed.

They had run hand in hand across the endless wilderness, feeling as if they could escape to the ends of the earth.

But in reality, they hadn't even made it ten kilometers before they were caught and taken back.

And Liang Shi bore all the consequences for their escape attempt.

Because the young little girl was adorable and cute, timid and didn't dare speak, and her family was willing to pay.

The kidnappers naturally treated her better.

But Liang Shi was different. Although she was also pretty, she didn't know how to sweet-talk people and just smiled foolishly all day.

The kidnappers called her an idiot, and she didn't argue.

She told Xu Qingzhu: "I have a universe in my heart. They don't understand."

But when ignorant adults savagely invaded a child's world, they never followed any rules.

It was like iron hooves trampling into a fairytale castle, instantly crushing it to ruins, the ruins turning to dust, not even smoke visible.

Those emotions preserved in memory were incredibly vivid. Even after so many years, they could still produce a sense of terror—a thousand, ten thousand times more frightening than any haunted house. And Xu Qingzhu's hands had almost lost all feeling.

The reason she could still maintain a shred of rationality was because Liang Shi was still fighting for her ahead, facing danger to protect her. So she had to protect herself and not become Liang Shi's burden.

Her gaze was focused on that sharp knife.